Codebook Task 1 – Economy

The purpose of the first coding task is to classify chunks of 3 sentences from the UN Debates Dataset into either "economic" or "not economic". This task will be based on Codebook from the Manifesto Project Database (Lehmann et al., 2025). This Codebook provides guidelines to classify political text into seven domains. However, for this task only the domain "Economy" will be used, while the rest will be classified as "not economic".

Classification as "economic"

Sub-categories of "Economy" from Manifesto Project Handbook (Lehmann et al. 2025):

Free Market Economy
Favourable mentions of the free market and free market capitalism as an economic model. May include favourable references to:

- Laissez-faire economy;
- Superiority of individual enterprise over state and control systems;
- Private property rights;
- Personal enterprise and initiative;
- Need for unhampered individual enterprises.

Incentives: Positive
Favourable mentions of supply side oriented economic policies (assistance to businesses rather than consumers). May include:

- Financial and other incentives such as subsidies, tax breaks etc.;
- Wage and tax policies to induce enterprise;
- Encouragement to start enterprises.

Market Regulation
Support for policies designed to create a fair and open economic market.
May include:

- Calls for increased consumer protection;
- Increasing economic competition by preventing monopolies and
- other actions disrupting the functioning of the market;
- Defence of small businesses against disruptive powers of big businesses;
- Social market economy

Economic Planning
Favourable mentions of long-standing economic planning by the government. Maybe:

- Policy plans, strategies, policy patterns etc.;
- Of a consultative or indicative nature.

Corporatism/Mixed Economy
Favourable mentions of cooperation of government, employers, and trade unions simultaneously. The collaboration of employers and employee organisations in overall economic planning supervised by the state.

Protectionism: Positive
Favourable mentions of extending or maintaining the protection of internal markets (by the manifesto or other countries). Measures may include:

- Tariffs;
- Quota restrictions;
- Export subsidies.

Protectionism: Negative
Support for the concept of free trade and open markets. Call for abolishing all means of market protection (in the manifesto or any other country).

Economic Goals
Broad and general economic goals that are not mentioned in relation to any other category. General economic statements that fail to include any specific goal.

Keynesian Demand Management
Favourable mentions of demand side oriented economic policies (assistance to consumers rather than businesses). Particularly includes increase private demand through

- Increasing public demand;
- Increasing social expenditures.

May also include:

- Stabilisation in the face of depression;
- Government stimulus plans in the face of economic crises.

Economic Growth: Positive
The paradigm of economic growth. Includes:

- General need to encourage or facilitate greater production;
- Need for the government to take measures to aid economic growth.

Technology and Infrastructure: Positive
Importance of modernisation of industry and updated methods of transport and communication. May include:

- Importance of science and technological developments in industry;
- Need for training and research within the economy (This does not imply education in general (see category 506);
- Calls for public spending on infrastructure such as roads and bridges;

- Support for public spending on technological infrastructure (e.g.:broadband internet, etc.).

Controlled Economy
Support for direct government control of economy. May include, for instance:
- Control over prices;
- Introduction of minimum wages.

Nationalisation
Favourable mentions of government ownership of industries, either partial or complete; calls for keeping nationalised industries in state hand or nationalising currently private industries. May also include favourable mentions of government ownership of land.

Economic Orthodoxy
Need for economically healthy government policy making. May include calls for:
- Reduction of budget deficits;
- Retrenchment in crisis;
- Thrift and savings in the face of economic hardship;
- Support for traditional economic institutions such as stock market and banking system;
- Support for strong currency.

Classification as "not economic"

In order to understand everything that is **not economic**, it might be helpful to look at all other domains from the manifesto project handbook.

Table 1: 56 Standard Policy Preferences in Seven Policy Domains

Domain 1: External Relations
- 101 Foreign Special Relationships: Positive
- 102 Foreign Special Relationships: Negative
- 103 Anti-Imperialism: Positive
- 104 Military: Positive
- 105 Military: Negative
- 106 Peace: Positive
- 107 Internationalism: Positive
- 108 European Integration: Positive
- 109 Internationalism: Negative
- 110 European Integration: Negative

Domain 2: Freedom and Democracy
- 201 Freedom and Human Rights: Positive
- 202 Democracy: Positive
- 203 Constitutionalism: Positive
- 204 Constitutionalism: Negative

Domain 3: Political System
- 301 Decentralisation: Positive
- 302 Centralisation: Positive
- 303 Governmental and Administrative Efficiency: Positive
- 304 Political Corruption: Negative
- 305 Political Authority: Positive

Domain 4: Economy
- 401 Free Enterprise: Positive
- 402 Incentives: Positive
- 403 Market Regulation: Positive
- 404 Economic Planning: Positive
- 405 Corporatism: Positive
- 406 Protectionism: Positive
- 407 Protectionism: Negative
- 408 Economic Goals
- 409 Keynesian Demand Management: Positive
- 410 Economic Growth
- 411 Technology and Infrastructure: Positive
- 412 Controlled Economy: Positive
- 413 Nationalisation: Positive
- 414 Economic Orthodoxy: Positive
- 415 Marxist Analysis: Positive
- 416 Anti-Growth Economy: Positive

Domain 5: Welfare and Quality of Life
- 501 Environmental Protection: Positive
- 502 Culture: Positive
- 503 Equality: Positive
- 504 Welfare State Expansion
- 505 Welfare State Limitation
- 506 Education Expansion
- 507 Education Limitation

Domain 6: Fabric of Society
- 601 National Way of Life: Positive
- 602 National Way of Life: Negative
- 603 Traditional Morality: Positive
- 604 Traditional Morality: Negative
- 605 Law and Order: Positive
- 606 Civic Mindedness: Positive
- 607 Multiculturalism: Positive
- 608 Multiculturalism: Negative

Domain 7: Social Groups
- 701 Labour Groups: Positive
- 702 Labour Groups: Negative
- 703 Agriculture: Positive
- 704 Middle Class and Professional Groups: Positive
- 705 Minority Groups: Positive
- 706 Non-Economic Demographic Groups: Positive

000 No meaningful category applies

We've decided to take 415 Marxist Analysis and 416 Anti-Growth Economy out of the definition of "economic", due to the following reasons:

- 415: Marxist Analysis: Analyzing if the text represent Marxist ideology or not would require a more complex political economy theory based deliberation, which is unnecessary for our project at this point.
- 416: sustainable development (SDGs) is a major agenda on its own in the UN debate that link to so many layers of topic in addition to economic, the text may contaminate our corpus with climate change, migration, education, health care if we decided to include this.

When looking at the other Domains, some mentionable categories that are not economic are: Military, Peace, Human Rights, Democracy, Constitutionalism, Political (De-)Centralization, Political Corruption, Environmental Protection, Culture, Welfare State, Education, Law and Order, Labour Groups, Minority Groups …

Examples and Edge Cases

Examples from UN Debates

> *Besides being morally shocking, this situation is economically inefficient, since it strangles economic growth. Furthermore, the implementation of structural adjustment programmes that began in the 1980s is a perfect illustration of bad global economic governance. The liberalization and privatization touted by such programmes were conducted anarchically; even today, such liberalization has been applied only in sectors where weak countries such as ours have no relative advantages. As we know, such liberalization did not affect the markets for labour or agricultural products.*

→ Annotation: **economic**

> *I welcome the enthusiasm of young people, in particular Paraguayan students, who in recent days made a united appeal for transparency in public administration and for quality education in Paraguay. We have confidence in the immense potential of our youth, and we firmly believe in the importance of access to high-quality education if we are to achieve the full progress of our nation. That is why we created a scholarship programme, the first phase of which will allow 1,500 Paraguayan professionals to complete master's degrees and doctorates in the best universities around the world. On 17 September, our Government, which is committed to transparency and to fighting corruption and its corrosive effects on the foundations of society, enacted the instrument regulating the law on free access to public information and government transparency, which allows all citizens to exercise their constitutional right to be informed.*

→ Annotation: **non-economic**

> *Namibia believes that the United Nations remains the centre for the consolidation of international rule of law. Therefore, the United Nations system should serve as a banner of transparency and accountability. For Governments and organizations such as the United Nations to regain the trust of people who have lost trust in global leadership over the years, inclusivity and transparency must be placed at the forefront of governance; for transparency plus accountability equals trust. Reforming the Security Council is therefore paramount.*

→ Annotation: **non-economic**

Edge Cases

> *The creation of a special international climate-change resilience facility to provide technical and financial resources should be given the most urgent attention possible. The existing global, economic and development architecture must facilitate that new development paradigm. Official development assistance must be re-engineered to take into account the vulnerability of small island States and the imperative of building resilience to climate change. The international financial institutions must rethink the classification of debt.*

→ Annotation: **economic**
Reasoning: While the main theme is International Development, it calls for regulatory changes in the international financial institutions. This will be classified as "economic" under the sub-class market regulation.

> *By recognizing climate vulnerability, we are building resilience against the grave impacts of climate change. We believe in the potential of the blue economy in advancing the conservation and sustainable use of the ocean and seas. Bangladesh has achieved exemplary success in building resilience against flood and other disasters. Crop intensification and the invention of water-resistant crops have helped us achieve self-sufficiency in food.*

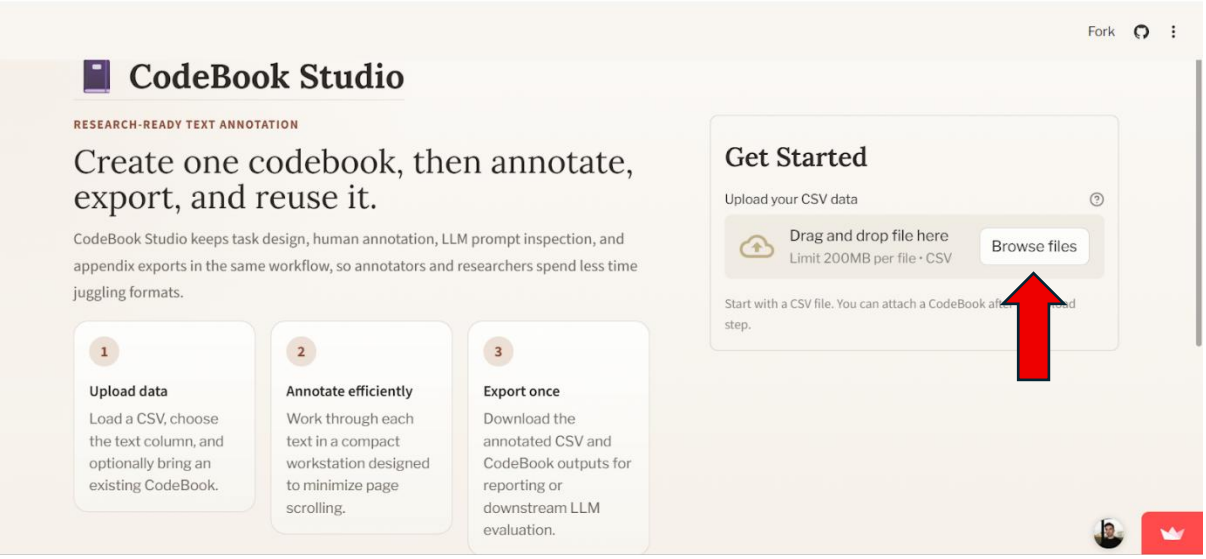
→ Annotation: **non-economic**
Reasoning: Mentions economy, but is overall about environmental protection

References

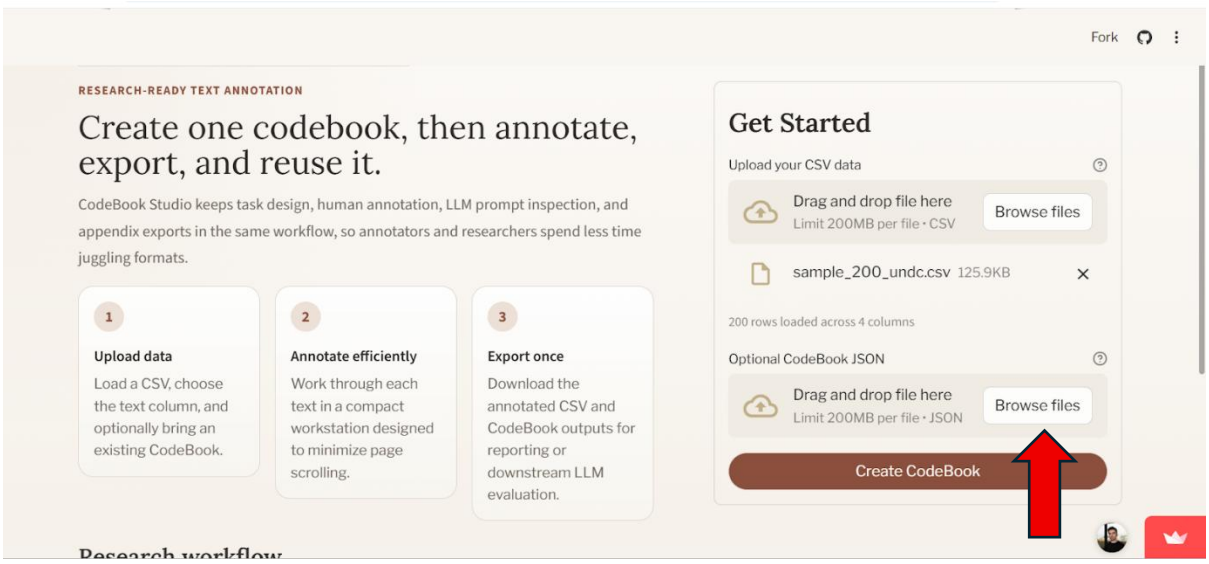
Lehmann, P., Franzmann, S., Al-Gaddooa, D., Burst, T., Ivanusch, C., Regel, S., Riethmüller, F., Volkens, A., Weßels, B. and Zehnter, L. (2025) The Manifesto Project Dataset – Codebook. Version 2025a. Berlin: Wissenschaftszentrum Berlin für Sozialforschung (WZB); Göttingen: Institut für Demokratieforschung (IfDem).

Annotation Instruction

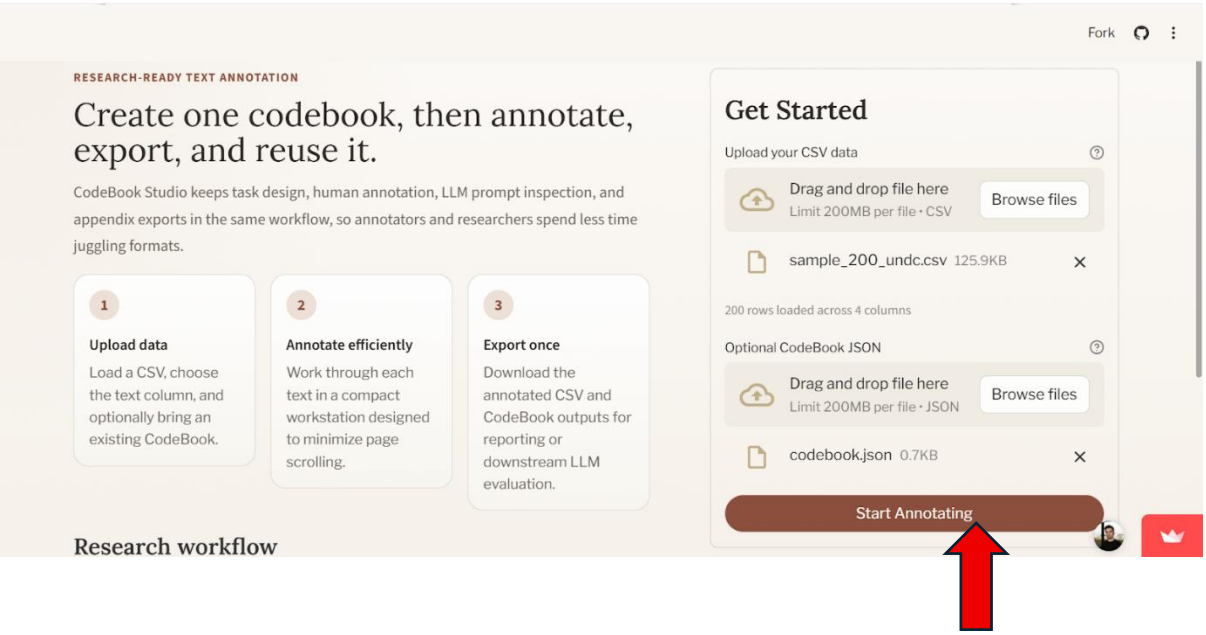
1. Upload the sample speech csv file into https://codebook.streamlit.app/



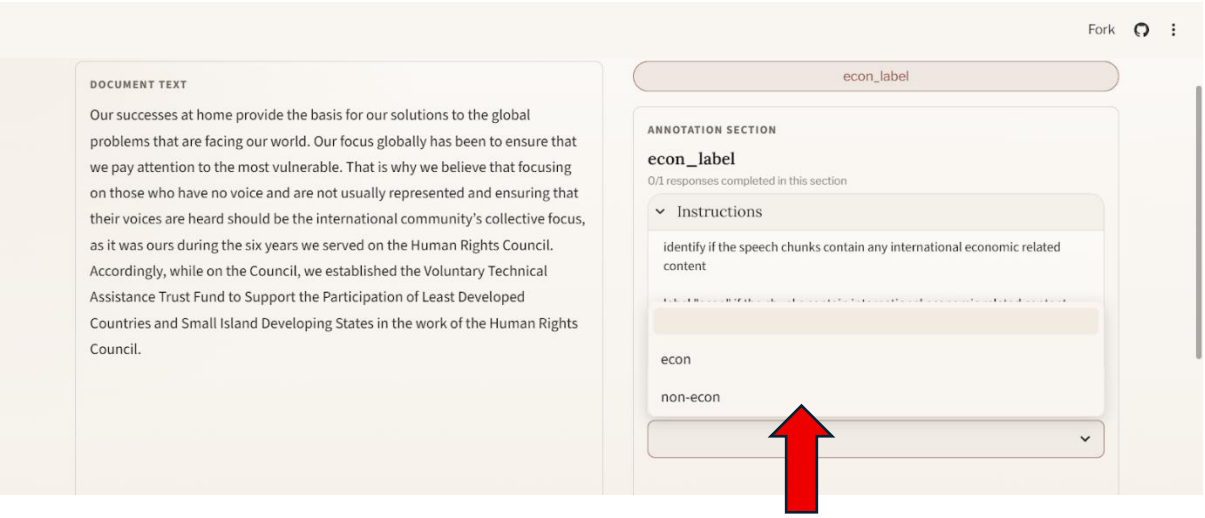
2. Upload the codebook_econ.jason file



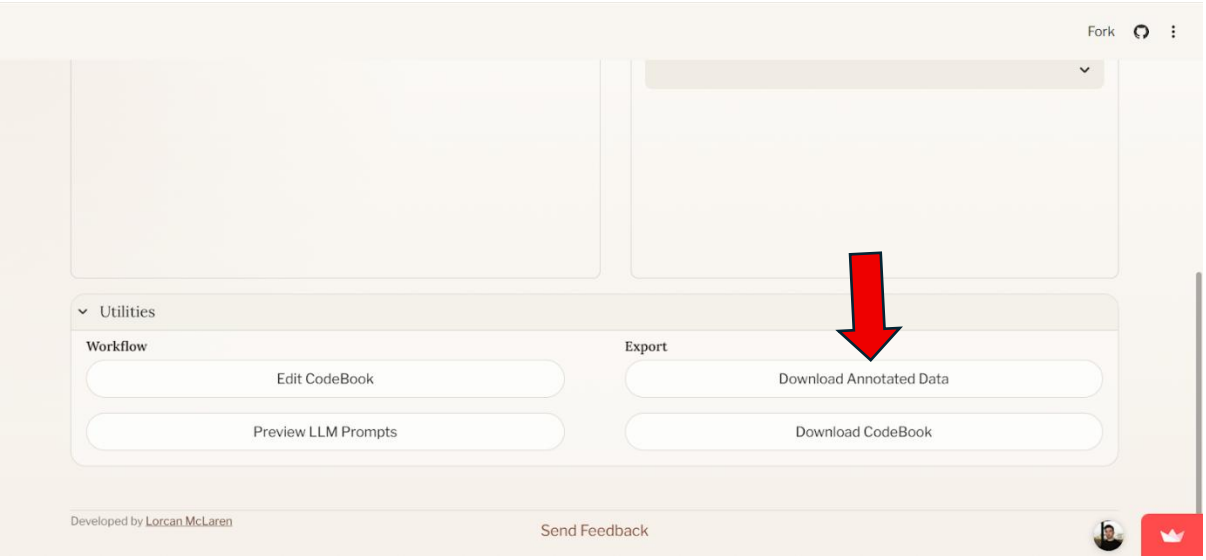
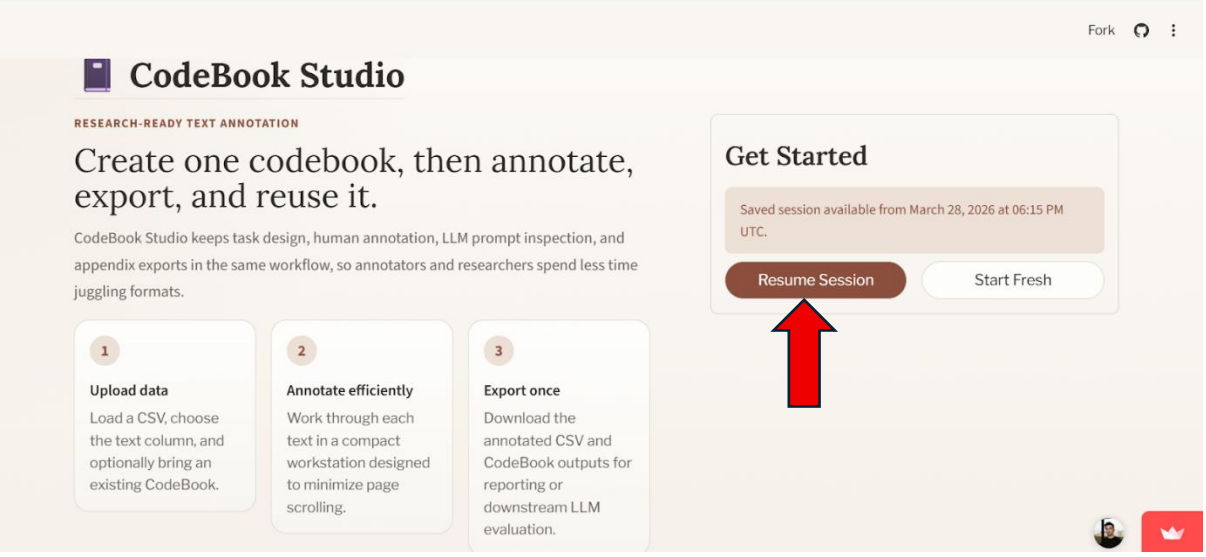
3. Click “start annotating”



4. Start annotating by reading the text on the right, and label the text in the drop-down toggle on the right



5. You can download your result so far from the “download annotated data” at the bottom section of the page



6. If you close the window the web app will automatically save your progress, you can get back to your current progress by simply going to the website from the same pc you were using in the first session of your annotation.